The 6:15

TUESDAY · OCTOBER 13, 2026 NO. 25

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Today, ~7a ET	Wells Fargo & JPMorgan Q3 (confirmed); not yet out as of press time, 6:20a ET. Street: WFC EPS $1.85 (vs. $1.66 y/a); JPM EPS ~$5.93 (vs. $5.07) **(consensus, not a verified wire survey)**
Wed 10/14, 8:30a	September CPI (BLS). Cleveland Fed nowcast ~3.6% headline vs. Aug.'s 3.4% **(nowcast, not a survey consensus)**
Thu 10/15	September PPI (BLS) **(date not independently verified this run)**
Oct. 27–28, 2p	FOMC decision; hike odds ~17–20% [continuity]
Nov. 1	OPEC+ ministerial [continuity]
Nov. 3	Midterm elections; CA Prop 40 wealth-tax fight (plus counter-measures Props 41/42) on statewide ballot [NEW]
Dec. 11	CR funding deadline [continuity]

No frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run — fourth straight issue skipping this sub-bullet. Citigroup/Goldman Tuesday reporting claims found only in a single secondary aggregator — not carried here as confirmed.

METRICS · AS OF ~6:20A ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	$104.42 (-2.09%) / $91.79 (-2.08%), spread ~$12.6 **(no settle yet — pre-NY-session level; Mon. 10/12 ICE/NYMEX settles were $106.68 / ~$91.9)**
10Y / 30Y / 5Y	5.24% / 5.60% / 5.02%, all flat **(Mon. 10/12 close carried over — bond market shut for Columbus Day; no fresh 2Y located)**
DXY	102.32 (-0.26%)
S&P / Nasdaq fut.	ES +0.06% to 7,863.00; NQ -0.47% to 30,752.25
VIX / Gold	15.30 (+0.59%) / $4,210.10 Dec. future (+0.47%)

Asia closes	Nikkei 67,777.52 (-1.82%); Hang Seng 24,345.22 (+0.30%); Shanghai Comp. 3,800.86 (+0.10%)
Europe / gas	DAX 25,406.83 (+0.51%, midday Frankfurt); AAA national retail gas $4.3413/gal today, down from $4.3669 Fri.

Mon. 10/12 cash close for context: S&P 500 7,807.24 (-0.06%), Dow 51,850.55 (+0.38%). Quotes above are Yahoo delayed/CME; no ICE/NYMEX settle available pre-session.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Strikes, Sept. 28–Oct. 5	12 tankers (oil/LNG/LPG) per Reuters/JMIC maritime-security sources; 9 vessel-incidents same week per IMO **(different trackers, same window — not reconciled)**
Strikes, single day	6 vessels struck Sun. 10/11 per UKMTO (5 tankers + 1 container ship; 5 in-strait, 1 off Oman's Sohar)
Transits vs. baseline	~3.2/day avg., Sept. 1–6 (IMF PortWatch) vs. 85.5/day 2025 norm **(5+ weeks stale — no October figure published)**
Regional flows	Kpler: Middle East crude exports 7-day avg. 18.5mn b/d as of Oct. 1, above pre-war levels
Dark-tanker count	24 of 85 Gulf-side tankers broadcasting mismatched identities (Windward, Anadolu Agency) **(~2 months stale)**
War-risk premia	7.5–12.5% of hull value/transit (Breakwave) vs. 0.25% pre-war **(5 weeks stale)**
Status	Rubio: "the Strait of Hormuz is open." IRGC's Naqdi: strait "closed," IRGC has "full control." Unreconciled.

Reuters/JMIC's 12, the IMO's 9, and UKMTO's single-day 6 measure different windows with different verification standards — never averaged or differenced here. Kpler's resilient regional-flow figure sits awkwardly against the strike counts above; see Iran & Hormuz for the reconciliation attempt. PortWatch's lag (~10 days by design) means the transit line is structurally always stale.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	No front-office move yet. Judge (Oct. 8) publicly pushed Steinbrenner/Cashman to go "all in"; Boone (1 yr. left) and Cashman (contract expired) status still open

Knicks	0-2 preseason, idle since Oct. 9 loss to Washington; at Toronto tonight, home Oct. 15 **(no result available as of press time)**
Northwestern	Beat Ball State 45-14 Sat. (Chiles: 272 yds., 3 pass TD + 1 rush TD); now 4-1

LEAD

HOUTHIS HIT RIYADH, TRUMP WEIGHS JOINING SAUDI FIGHT, AND THE IRAN TALKS STALL OVER WHO'S LEFT TO TALK TO

A second front opens on the Arabian Peninsula just as Washington admits its own strikes emptied the room across the table from Tehran

Houthi missiles have hit Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport on three straight days — Saturday (13 dead, including one US citizen, and more than 300 wounded), Sunday (one more dead, 11 hurt), and a claimed Monday strike plus a drone attack on a base at Khamis Mushait that Saudi-led forces say they intercepted. [fact] Separate strikes earlier in the week also hit Abha airport; officials put the week's death toll across all the attacks at 20-plus. [fact] The airport has been closed since Saturday and stayed closed through Monday's 8:48a update; Delta has pushed its planned Atlanta-Riyadh route back to March 2027. [fact] Saudi Arabia has opened an inquiry into why its air defenses failed to stop the strikes. [fact] Trump said Saturday the US "may" join Saudi Arabia's campaign against the Houthis and would decide quickly; by Monday he was calling the group's conduct "misbehaving very badly." [fact] A Houthi spokesman, Mohammed Al Bukhaiti, told AFP any US involvement would bring a "swift and painful response" against American interests in the region and named Saudi oil and airport workers as "legitimate targets." [NEW, fact, flag: single AFP attribution for the threat] Overnight into Tuesday the Houthis said Saudi aircraft struck

Kamaran island and Jawf province and that they downed a Saudi drone over Saada; Riyadh did not confirm either claim. [fact, flag]

That escalation lands on top of, not instead of, the Iran war the past several issues have tracked — and Trump supplied the line connecting them. In remarks at a rally this week he said the US is struggling to negotiate with Tehran because so many regime figures have been killed in American and Israeli strikes: "We might have gone too far with the leaders because we don't know who the hell we're dealing with anymore." [NEW, fact, flag: the source's own rally location/date is internally inconsistent — text says Ohio, a photo caption says Tennessee on Oct. 10] That is, in effect, an admission that the decapitation campaign Axios reported the Pentagon was told to keep preparing (issue No. 24) has a direct cost: it degrades the other side's capacity to make a deal stick, independent of whether Washington wants one. [read] Mechanically, a Houthi front — fellow Iran-aligned actors, now explicitly threatening Saudi energy infrastructure — gives Tehran a proxy escalation option that doesn't require Iran's own depleted leadership to act directly, right as the US has tried to time-box its own Iran strikes to after Nov. 3. [read] Iran's security chief Mohsen Rezaei said Saturday the US reply to Tehran's seven-point Hormuz-reopening plan was "insufficient" — Washington accepted some conditions, left others unaddressed — and that Iran won't soften its terms. [fact] Qatar's Emir on Tuesday called for doubled efforts to secure Gulf navigation and protect energy facilities, a sign the anxiety is no longer bilateral; Iran's foreign minister Araghchi separately discussed Yemen and regional de-escalation with his Egyptian counterpart Tuesday, the first sign this run of Cairo working the Houthi angle diplomatically. [fact] None of this has

altered the hardware trajectory flagged in issue No. 24 — the Theodore Roosevelt strike group is still inbound to bring the US to three simultaneous Middle East carriers, with arrival-timing estimates still split between late October and late November depending on the source — so a Houthi-focused US response would layer onto, not replace, that buildup. [continuity, fact/flag]

The market's read on all this is messy rather than clean. Brent settled Monday at $106.68, +1.86%, as the Riyadh attacks and the ongoing Hormuz tanker campaign (12 ships hit Sept. 28-Oct. 5 per Reuters/JMIC) pushed a risk premium back into the price. [fact] Premarket Tuesday it has given back more than that move, to $104.42 (-2.09% as of 6:07a ET) alongside WTI's -2.08% to $91.79. [fact] Nothing in the news flow explains the reversal cleanly — it may be profit-taking after Monday's jump, positioning ahead of today's bank earnings and tomorrow's CPI, or a read that a Houthi-focused US response is a lower-probability, lower-intensity escalation than a direct Iran campaign would be. [read, flag: mechanism not confirmed by any source] What is not in dispute is that OPEC+ is already holding output flat for a second straight month (31.01mn b/d, next review Nov. 1) and that Kpler's regional export data still shows Middle East crude flows at or above pre-war levels despite the worst strike tempo of the war — an divergence between the attack headlines and the physical-barrel data that the Iran & Hormuz section below tries to reconcile rather than paper over. [fact/read] For the investor: the Riyadh-Houthi thread is the more trade-able near-term risk precisely because it's less constrained by the midterm-timing promise Trump has made on Iran directly, and Saudi energy infrastructure — not Iranian — is the explicit threatened target.

POLITICS

The Nov. 3 midterms are three weeks out, and California's ballot carries the marquee economic-policy fight of the cycle: Proposition 40, a billionaire wealth tax that backers refused to withdraw despite pressure from Gov. Newsom, now faces two industry-backed countermeasures, Propositions 41 and 42, on the same ballot. [NEW, fact] Fourteen measures are on the statewide ballot in total, five from the legislature and nine by initiative. [fact] Prop 40 would levy an annual tax on net worth above a threshold aimed at the state's billionaire residents; Props 41 and 42 are industry-backed responses designed to blunt or complicate it rather than repeal it outright, and both qualified only after Prop 40's backers declined Newsom's request to withdraw. [fact] For investors, the number to watch isn't just California's own revenue math — a passed wealth tax, even one likely tied up in litigation, would be the first state-level precedent other legislatures could cite directly. Separately, the continuing resolution signed in September still funds the government through Dec. 11, pushing any shutdown fight past the election [continuity] — no new fiscal-calendar development this run.

ECONOMICS

Wednesday's 8:30a September CPI is the next hard catalyst: the Cleveland Fed's nowcast puts headline at roughly 3.6%, up from August's confirmed 3.4%, though that is a model nowcast, not a surveyed Street consensus — none was verified this run. [fact/flag] Thursday brings PPI, unconfirmed by a second source this run. [flag] FOMC hike odds for the Oct. 27-28 meeting remain low, around 17-20%, little changed from issue No. 24's reading, with softer payrolls and inflation data cited as the reason odds fell from roughly 55%

earlier in October. [fact, flag: single dated source for the odds-move claim] That holds the fed funds target at the 3.75-4.00% range set by September's hike, itself a response to inflation and the energy-price shock from the Hormuz war. [continuity, fact] Retail gas ticked down to $4.3413/gal nationally (AAA, today) from $4.3669 three days ago [fact] — a small give-back even as crude whipsawed, consistent with a lag between crude moves and pump prices rather than a signal of its own. Wednesday's CPI print is the more immediate test of whether the energy shock has broadened into core inflation, which would cut against the market's current low odds of an October hike.

BUSINESS

Wells Fargo and JPMorgan open Q3 bank earnings this morning, premarket, with results not yet out as of this writing (6:20a ET); Street estimates — not verified wire-survey figures — put Wells Fargo EPS at $1.85 (vs. $1.66 a year ago) on $22.34bn revenue, and JPMorgan at roughly $5.93 (vs. $5.07) on about $51.2bn. [flag: consensus only] Wells Fargo has beaten estimates for 10 straight quarters per Bespoke data, and JPMorgan's Q2 came in well ahead of its own consensus, so the bar going in is high on both names. [fact] A claim that Citigroup and Goldman Sachs also report Tuesday came from a single secondary aggregator and is not carried here as confirmed. [flag] In Monday's session, CCC Intelligent Solutions surged 9.54% on reports of advanced buyout talks involving GTCR and Elliott Investment Management, and eBay rose more than 5% after Morgan Stanley named it a top pick and lifted its price target to $132. [NEW, fact]

TECHNOLOGY

The memory-chip selloff tied to China's CXMT — the Shanghai-listed DRAM maker whose July IPO popped 466% on debut to a roughly $485bn valuation — is still working through the sector: Sandisk and Micron were both lower again in Monday's session (Sandisk roughly -5%, Micron close to -4%) as investors continue to price in Chinese entry into advanced memory. [fact] The distinction that matters: CXMT makes DRAM, not NAND, so Sandisk's larger repeated hit is a read on where investors expect Chinese chipmakers to move next, not a direct competitive threat today. [read] By Counterpoint's Q2 count, Micron's DRAM share actually rose to 24% even as SK Hynix's fell to 25% from 29%, a reminder that the post-IPO selloff has not obviously tracked the underlying share data. [fact] No frontier AI model release, from any major lab, was confirmed this run — the fourth consecutive issue without a verified entry for that sub-bullet, against scattered single-source chatter about imminent Gemini, GPT, and Anthropic releases that none of the primary labs has confirmed. [flag]

GEOPOLITICS

OPEC+'s Nov. 1 ministerial is the next scheduled decision point after October's hold at 31.01mn b/d combined output [continuity] — no new reporting on the group's internal deliberations this run. Qatar's Emir, Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani, used a Tuesday address to call for "doubled" efforts to secure Gulf navigation and protect energy facilities and civilian infrastructure, framing the country as facing "exceptional circumstances" — the clearest sign yet that Gulf states outside the direct US-Iran-Saudi triangle are treating the shipping risk as their own, not just a bystander's problem. [NEW, fact] Qatar's position is awkward by geography alone: it sits across the Gulf from the strait's chokepoint, hosts the US's largest regional air base, and has acted as a mediator passing messages between Washington and Tehran on the stalled Hormuz proposal — so a call to "secure navigation" reads as much as self-interest as diplomacy. [read] No fresh, dated Russia-Ukraine reporting was located this run [gap, not re-used from issue No. 23 rather than re-adjectived].

IRAN & HORMUZ

Iran's security council chief Mohsen Rezaei said Saturday that Washington's response to Tehran's seven-condition plan to reopen the strait was "insufficient" — the US had accepted some conditions and left others unaddressed, he said, and Iran won't soften its position without clarity on the rest. [fact] The plan, presented at the UN General Assembly, would reopen Hormuz and resume nuclear talks within a week in exchange for the US lifting its naval blockade, easing restrictions on Iranian oil sales, and restoring a regional

ceasefire; Trump rejected an earlier version of it in late September. [continuity, fact]

Beyond the Lead's numbers, a Panama-flagged crude carrier, Gem No 2, was struck by a drone roughly 25km west of Al Jazeera, UAE, this week; the fire was extinguished and all 22 crew were reported safe. [NEW, fact] A separate vessel was reportedly hit by projectiles about 95km north of Madinat ash Shamal, Qatar, with casualties reported — continuity with the Fujairah/Madinat ash Shamal spillover zone flagged in issue No. 24. [DEVELOPING, fact, flag: single-sourced, casualty count not given] The IRGC claimed a Monday strike on a supertanker transiting with its transponders off; that claim, like Saturday's mine-strike claim that shipping analyst Sal Mercogliano said the released video didn't actually support, is unconfirmed independently. [flag]

The reconciliation this issue owes on the Board's divergence: Kpler's provisional data shows regional Middle East crude exports running at a 7-day average of 18.5mn b/d as of Oct. 1 — above pre-war levels — even as the attack trackers above describe the worst strike tempo of the war. [fact] The two aren't necessarily in conflict: Kpler counts loaded cargo that clears the region by any route and excludes dark-fleet vessels with transponders off, while the strike counts measure discrete attack events concentrated in the strait itself. A high attack count can coexist with resilient aggregate flows if shippers are increasingly routing around the strait, absorbing the war-risk premium, or simply accepting the odds on any single transit — which is consistent with Lloyd's List's (undated, pre-October) estimate that dark transits made up over 80% of Hormuz passages after the ceasefire collapsed. [read] Marco Rubio's "the Strait of Hormuz is open" and the IRGC's Mohammadreza Naqdi's

"closed...full control" claims describe the same waterway from two sides that each have reason to overstate their control of it; neither is treated here as the operative fact. [flag]

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over — swept by Rays in ALDS. No front-office move yet; Judge pushing ownership to go "all in," Boone's and Cashman's status unresolved.
Knicks	0-2 preseason, idle since Oct. 9 loss to Washington; at Toronto tonight, home Oct. 15.
Northwestern	Beat Ball State 45-14 Saturday at Ryan Field; now 4-1 overall.

Continuity. Yankees/Knicks/Northwestern threads carried at the state left in issue No. 24; OPEC+ hold, CR deadline, and FOMC odds restated briefly rather than re-reported since nothing moved. No frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified for a fourth straight issue.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. Single-sourced items: the Al Bukhaiti AFP threat quote, the rally location/date for Trump's "gone too far" remark, the Citigroup/Goldman Tuesday-reporting claim, the Madinat ash Shamal casualty report, both IRGC strike claims this week, and the oil reversal's cause. PortWatch transit and Breakwave war-risk figures are stale by 5+ weeks; the Windward dark-tanker figure by ~2 months — carried forward and flagged rather than re-estimated. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.